

Segment 30 Lake Elinor Outlet to Campsite 15 (Craig Lake State Park)

(Formerly Segment 27), Updated April 2026 [Google Map of Segment 30](#) The Google Map is only for an overview of the trail. **Use Avenza Maps for actually locating and following the trail.**

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Segment length: About 3.5 miles, east to west 324 ft of ascent, 323 ft of descent

Link to: [Avenza Maps Online](#). Use Maps # 33 and 34 in the Avenza app. Make sure you have the current updates for Avenza. Always refer to the updated Avenza Maps for the most current NCT mile markers.

Please contact mac@northcountrytrail.org or the Trail Adopter above with reports of trail conditions, including blowdowns, washouts or inadequate blazing, or if you have questions on driving directions to the start point.

Many of the backroads have multiple names depending on which map you are using. When known, multiple names for the same road have been indicated in italics within brackets.

On the trail: (all trail descriptions will be westbound, follow in reverse for eastbound)

This segment begins at a pedestrian bridge over the west branch of the Peshekee River at the Lake Elinor outlet. (46.627707,-88.099883) Heading eastbound the first 1/2 mile is a single track along the river with some nice vistas and an area cleared for camping at the bend in the river just west of the bridge. The next two miles is a two track and eventually enters Craig Lake State Park. Just steps west of the first pedestrian bridge within the park is a designated Campsite 16, but there is no evidence of a campsite whatsoever. Proceed another 1.5 miles west, crossing another pedestrian bridge over the outlet of Crooked Lake, to Campsite 15 which is signed, has a tent pad, fire ring, and an outdoor commode. The segment ends at Campsite 15 (46.625725,-88.157745), within Craig Lake State Park.

Driving Directions

Eastern Trailhead:

The actual western trailhead is not reachable via vehicle. We recommend that you either leave your vehicle at the Avenza parking area at (46.627577,-88.084852) and walk the trail roughly one mile to the west end of the segment, or combine this short segment with an adjacent segment. Driving directions/map to this recommended parking are as follows. From Marquette, take US-41 west through Champion and past Van Riper State Park. Just after crossing the Peshekee River, turn right (north) on [County Rd. (CR) 607/Peshekee Grade Rd./Huron Bay Grade]. This road is blacktopped but is very rough in spots, so drive slowly. Stay on [County Rd. (CR) 607/Peshekee Grade Rd./Huron Bay Grade] for about 7.4 miles. (Be sure not to take Dishno Rd to the right at around mile 4.1.) Turn left onto the unnamed dirt road. There is a sign with a number of names at this intersection. Continue for about 1.5 miles and stay to the right. Continue about .7 miles and again bear right. In another .6 miles, turn left. Continue for about 1.2 miles to where the NCT crosses. Using the following Google Map is strongly recommended. [Driving map to parking east of Lake Elinor Outlet](#)

Western Trailhead:

The western trailhead is not reachable via vehicle. While backcountry maps may show some two tracks nearby, they are located on gated and private land and should not be attempted for parking purposes.

Camping:

Craig Lake State Park backcountry campsites will be by reservation only starting in 2023. [Backcountry reservations at Craig Lake State Park](#) Camping season runs from May 20 through November 1. All overnight backpackers will be required to make a backcountry reservation for a specific campsite. Dispersed camping is not allowed. Long distance NCNST hikers can call Van Riper State Park Campground Office at (906) 339-4461 prior to their hike to inform the DNR that they are traveling through and DNR staff can check them in. Hikers will be allowed to print reservation papers and have them available should a backcountry ranger ask to see them.

Water Access:

Water is available along the west branch of the Peshekee River, at several water crossings and at the outlet to Crooked Lake.

Seasonal Access Information:

From late spring through early winter a higher clearance vehicle is necessary to reach parking for the eastern trailhead. The parking area is not reachable via vehicle in the wintertime.